

Final Database Seeder

We have a way to seed random jobs and users, which is ok, but I want to work with the same group of jobs. I also want to truncate the tables first. We can do this by using the `truncate` method on the `DB` facade. We can also use the `call` method to call another seeder from within another seeder.

Attached to this lesson is a download for a `job_listings.php` file which returns an array of 10 job listings. I want to use this to seed our database. Put this file in the `database/seeder/data` directory. You will have to create the `data` directory.

Let's create a new seeder called `JobSeeder.php` in the `database/seeder` directory. We can use the `make:seeder` command to create a new seeder.

```
php artisan make:seeder JobSeeder
```

This will create a file at `database/seeder/JobSeeder.php`. This file will contain a class called `JobSeeder` that extends the `Seeder` class. It will have a method called `run`. This is where we will define the logic for populating our database with data.

We need to bring in the `DB` facade and the `User` model:

```
use Illuminate\Support\Facades\DB;
use App\Models\User;
```

This is because we will be using the `DB` facade to insert data and we need to get a user id for each job.

Add the following code for the `run` method:

```
public function run(): void
{
    // Load job listings data
    $jobListings = include database_path('seeder/data/job_listings.php');

    // Get all user IDs
    $userIds = User::pluck('id')->toArray();

    foreach ($jobListings as &$listing) {
        // Assign a random user_id to each job listing
        $listing['user_id'] = $userIds[array_rand($userIds)];
        // Add timestamps
        $listing['created_at'] = now();
        $listing['updated_at'] = now();
    }

    // Insert job listings
```

```
DB::table('job_listings')->insert($jobListings);  
}
```

We are getting the data from the `job_listings.php` file and then assigning a random user id to each job listing.

We are using the `pluck` method to get all the user ids and then we are using the `array_rand` function to get a random user id.

We are also adding timestamps to each job listing.

We are then using the `insert` method on the `DB` facade to insert the data into the database.

We can call this seeder on it's own, however what I would like to do is call this along with the user seeder in the main `DatabaseSeeder.php` file. We can do this by using the `call` method. I also want to truncate the tables first. We can do this by using the `truncate` method on the `DB` facade.

Open the `DatabaseSeeder.php` file and add bring in the `DB` facade:

```
use Illuminate\Support\Facades\DB;
```

Now add the following code to the `run` method:

```
public function run(): void  
{  
    // Truncate tables  
    DB::table('job_listings')->truncate();  
    DB::table('users')->truncate();  
  
    $this->call(RandomUserSeeder::class);  
    $this->call(JobSeeder::class);  
}
```

We are clearing the tables and then calling the user seeder, which creates 10 random users. We are then calling the job seeder, which creates our 10 listings from the array and uses a random user id for each listing.

Now run the seeder:

```
php artisan db:seed
```

Now whenever you want to reset the database, you can run the `db:seed` command. This will clear the tables and then add the 10 job listings and 10 random users to our database. Now we have some data to work with. In the next section, we will start to work on the presentation of our site.